

Week 7 Class Activity

Mock Retrospective Activity

Duration: 60 minutes

Background

In Agile, metrics guide teams toward improvement rather than punishment or competition. They help answer key questions:

- Are we delivering value to our customers?
- Are we improving sprint by sprint?
- Are we maintaining a sustainable pace and good team health?

This mock retrospective gives you the chance to experience how Agile teams interpret metrics, discuss challenges, and agree on improvements for the next sprint.

You'll act as a Scrum team reflecting on real metrics from a fictional project, SmartTasks.

Learning Goals

By the end of this activity, you will be able to:

1. Interpret both quantitative (numbers) and qualitative (insight-based) Agile metrics.
2. Identify key strengths, issues, and patterns in team performance.
3. Conduct a short team retrospective focused on continuous improvement.
4. Communicate findings clearly to others in a discussion setting.

Scenario: "SmartTasks" Project

Your team is developing a task-management app called SmartTasks.

You've completed three sprints, and the team's Scrum Master has collected the following metrics.

Sprint Metrics Data

Metric	Sprint 1	Sprint 2	Sprint 3
Velocity (Story Points Completed)	25	30	22
Defects Found After Release	5	2	7

Cycle Time (Average Days per Story)	4.5	3.5	5
Team Happiness (1–5 Scale)	4.0	3.8	3.0
Customer Satisfaction (1–5 Scale)	4.2	4.4	4.0
Scope Changes During Sprint	1	0	3

Metric Reminders

- Velocity = work completed each sprint; stable velocity = predictability.
- Defects = bugs reaching production; fewer = better quality.
- Cycle time = how fast stories move from start to done.
- Team happiness = survey of morale and collaboration.
- Customer satisfaction = user feedback rating.
- Scope changes = work added after planning, often a cause of pressure.

Team Roles (suggested)

Role	Responsibility
Scrum Master	Facilitates discussion, keeps time.
Recorder	Takes notes of main points and action items.
Analyst(s)	Interprets data and explains patterns.
Presenter	Shares final summary in the discussion forum.

If you're working individually, simply perform each step yourself and post your own summary.

Instructions

Step 1: Review the Data (10 minutes)

As a group, study the metrics table carefully.

Discuss:

- What is improving or declining across the sprints?

- What relationships might exist between metrics? (e.g., more defects → lower morale)
- Are there warning signs of technical debt, over-commitment, or burnout?

Step 2: Conduct a Mock Retrospective (25 minutes)

Hold a short retrospective using the Start – Stop – Continue framework.

Category	Guiding Questions
Start	What new actions should the team begin doing next sprint?
Stop	What habits or practices should be stopped?
Continue	What's going well that should continue?

Aim to identify at least three concrete improvement ideas.

Example:

- Start mid-sprint test reviews.

Step 3: Write a Team Summary (10 minutes)

Create a short written summary (about 200 words) including:

1. Top 3 Insights from the metrics.
2. 3 Proposed Action Items for the next sprint.
3. 1 Reflection Sentence on how metrics supported your team discussion.

Example:

Velocity dropped from 30 → 22 points while happiness and quality declined. Cycle time increased, suggesting the team may be over-committed. Customer satisfaction stayed steady, so value is still being delivered.

Actions: limit sprint scope; add mid-sprint testing; hold morale check-ins.

Reflection: Using metrics helped reveal how delivery pressure affects team well-being.

Step 4: Share & Discuss (15 minutes)

1. Post your team's Retrospective Summary to the class Discussion Forum.
2. Read at least one other team's post and reply with:
 - One positive comment or insight you appreciated.
 - One suggestion for an additional metric or improvement idea.

Step 5: Build an Agile Metrics Dashboard (30 minutes)

Now that you've analyzed and discussed the SmartTasks metrics, your team will create a simple Agile Metrics Dashboard, a drawing or prototype that visually represents the key metrics and trends you discovered.

This step is about turning your analysis into a visual story that communicates the team's progress and health.

Instructions

1. Scenario:

Imagine that your Scrum Master has asked your team to prepare a Sprint Health Dashboard for the next sprint review.

The goal is to show your team's performance and insights at a glance using the metrics from the three SmartTasks sprints.

2. Using the data provided above, design a dashboard prototype that includes at least four visual elements such as:

- Velocity Trend (Sprint 1 → Sprint 3): bar or line chart
- Defects Found: bar or line chart showing quality over time
- Team Happiness: simple numeric or emoji-based graph (😊 😐 😞)
- Cycle Time: changes in average days per story
- (Optional bonus) Include Customer Satisfaction or Scope Changes if you wish

3. Tools:

You may create your dashboard in any drawing or page-editing software you like, for example:

- Canva, PowerPoint, Figma, Google Slides, Miro, Jamboard, Paint, or even Word Shapes.
- You can also hand-draw it neatly on paper and upload a photo.
The purpose is to prototype how an Agile metrics dashboard might look, focus on clarity, not artistic perfection.

4. Add a short "Sprint Health Summary" (3–4 sentences) below your visuals that explains what your dashboard shows.

Example:

"Velocity dropped in Sprint 3 while defects and cycle time increased, suggesting instability.

Team happiness also declined, likely due to scope changes. Next sprint should focus on limiting scope and improving testing coverage."

5. Share your dashboard in the same Discussion Forum where you posted your retrospective summary.

Include:

- The image or link to your dashboard prototype.
- A short note explaining your design choices (why you picked certain visuals or colors).